



Long jumper

The red kangaroo bounds along on its enormous back legs, using its strong tail to help it balance. A big male kangaroo can clear more than 30 ft (9 m) in one leap. Usually only the male has red fur. The female is blue-gray in color.

Red kangaroo
(*Osphranter rufus*)
Height: up to 4 ft 7 in (1.4 m)
Tail: up to 3 ft 3 in (1 m)



Central desert marsupial mole
(*Notoryctes typhlops*)
Length: up to 5.5 in (14 cm)

Tunneling mole

The marsupial mole uses its long claws to dig tunnels in soft sand dunes. Its body is a smooth, streamlined shape and it pushes easily through the sand. The mole spends all of its life underground in dark tunnels, so it has no eyes.

Big eater

The mulgara eats up to 25 percent of its own weight in meat every day, eating mice, birds, and small lizards. During the day, the mulgara stays in its burrow, out of the heat.



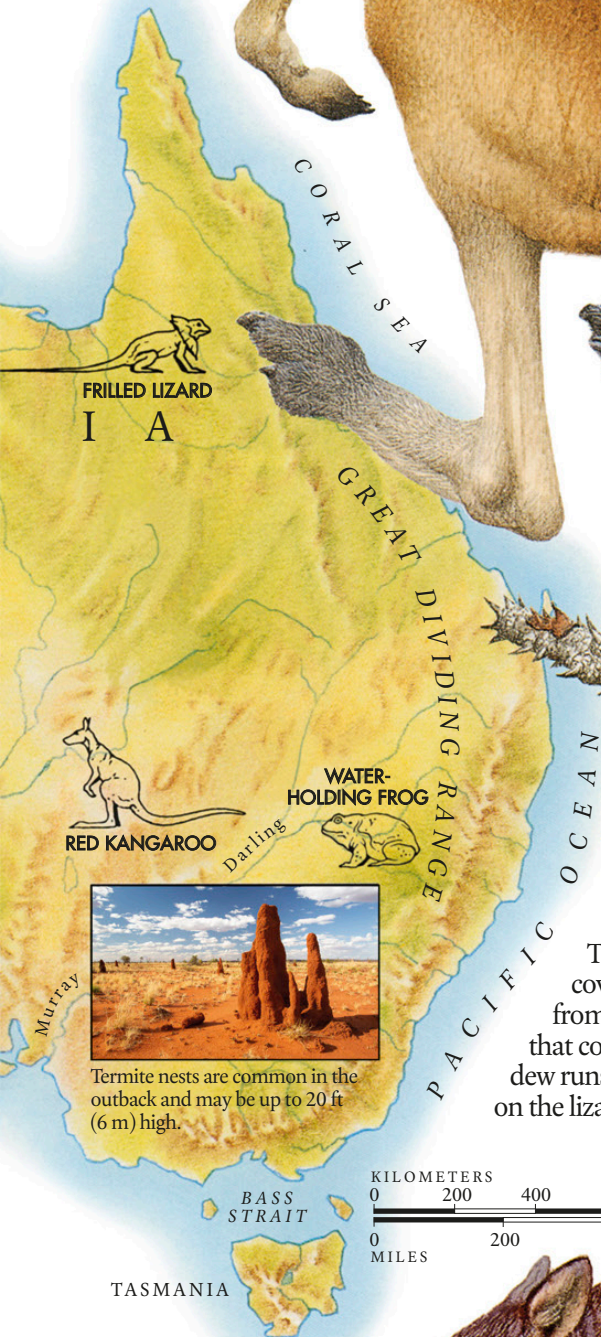
Brush-tailed mulgara
(*Dasymercus blythi*)
Length including tail: up to 10 in (26.5 cm)

Centralian blue-tongued skink
(*Tiliqua multifasciata*)
Length: up to 17.7 in (45 cm)



Scary tongue

When a blue-tongued skink is frightened, it puts out its bright blue tongue and makes a hissing sound. Although this display may help scare off attackers, the skink is really quite harmless.



Thorny devil
(*Moloch horridus*)
Length including tail: up to 7.8 in (20 cm)

Desert devil

The thorny devil is a type of lizard covered in hard spines to protect it from attack. It gets liquid from dew that collects on its skin at night. The dew runs along thousands of tiny grooves on the lizard's skin into its mouth.

Wild dog

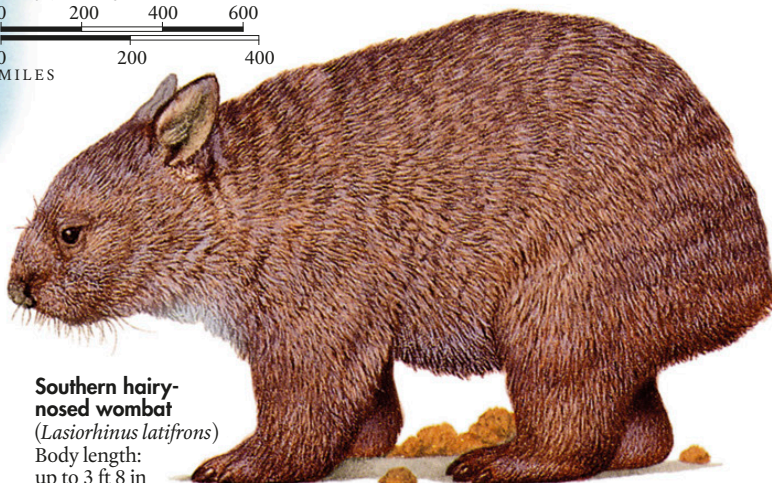
Dingos are descended from domesticated dogs that people brought to Australia about 4,000 years ago, but they have become wild again. Dingos yelp or howl instead of barking.



Dingo (*Canis lupus dingo*)
Height at shoulder: up to 20 in (50 cm)
Length: up to 3 ft 3 in (1 m)

Huge burrow

The Southern hairy-nosed wombat avoids the heat of the day by staying in a deep burrow, which can be up to 100 ft (30 m) long. Feeding mainly on grass, it can go without water for months at a time.



Southern hairy-nosed wombat
(*Lasiorhinus latifrons*)
Body length: up to 3 ft 8 in (111 cm)

Water tank

The water-holding frog stores water in its bladder. A large frog can hold half its own weight in water. It also produces an outer layer of skin that forms a watery cocoon around its body, helping it survive in droughts.



Water-holding frog
(*Cyclorana platycephalus*)
Length: up to 2 in (6 cm)